

Spider Web

And other

Completely

Awesome

Activities



Facilitate like a Professional!

Two ways we can help you do that:

- 1. Attend a live, 2-Day Facilitator Training Course**
 - We hold an open enrollment facilitator training every quarter and hit every area of the country.
 - Experiential learning at its best - you practice everything you learn!
- 2. Join our Facilitator Membership and learn all the tips and tricks from our professional facilitators.**
 - Video, audio, PDFs and more - you learn at your own pace.
 - Cancel at any time and use as much as you like.

Visit our website, www.TeamBuildingActivity.com for more information. You can also call us at 800-513-8759 and speak with any of our facilitators for help.

Table of Contents

Spider Web	4
Horizontal Web Setup	11
Electric Fence	14
Hole in Space	18
Support	20

Spider Web

Objective

For the entire group to travel through the web to the other side, without touching the web. Each participant must travel through a different opening in the web.

This requires the entire team to manage their differences (size, disposition, strength, intelligence, etc.), it requires commitment, it's very physical without being strenuous, and it's fun.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- PVC Frame
- Web made from bungee
- Guidebook



Potential Storyline

You are trying to access your favorite web site, but there is a limitation on the number of users that can be simultaneously logged on. If you happen to connect with the wrong server, everyone in the group gets logged off.

Setup of Activity

Vertical Setup

1. Build Frame.
 - You will not need all of the PVC pieces for the vertical frame setup.
 - We recommend you leave the footing support for last.
 - On page 5 is an illustration so you can see what is needed for the frame and an image of what the frame will look like when completed.
 - Page 6 shows the frame broken into pieces so you can easily see which piece goes where.
2. Retrieve web from stuff sack and spread out on the ground.
3. Find the small 1/8" rope, typically pink or black. This is top center. Put it in the middle and begin attaching the rope to the velcro on the PVC. On page 7 is an illustration of the web attached to the PVC frame.

4. When the frame is ready, say to the group, “you have 5 minutes to plan your technique. At the end of that time, I would like to review your plan with you, BEFORE you begin.” This review process encourages the group to plan, but more importantly, it provides the facilitator with every detail of movement, so that they may anticipate appropriate spotting positions before a participant begins their passage.
5. Once you give them the basic outline, give them the handout on page 6.
6. As with many challenges that have a visible sign of error, in this case that means contact with the web, allow the group to inspect their own movements, rather than setting yourself up as the judge. This places the responsibility directly on the group for their performance.
7. In addition to watching the web for contact, there is a bell so that the contact is more easily noted. In the event of contact, offer an option to the group, such as, “you can either start again from the beginning, or, you can pass two people through that are connected together.” This allows the group to decide their fate, and involves a conscious choice, rather than a penalty or consequence.

Safety Considerations

- In many cases, participants may choose to lift other participants through the web. Encourage appropriate spotting techniques, especially focused on the shoulders and head region of the participant being transported.
- Discourage any passage through the web that does not involve contact with other participants. This will prevent jumping and unspotted movement.
- Do not allow any one to dive through the web. NO HEADFIRST! Stop the action if this is about to happen.
- When they are lifting some one, remind them to protect the participant's neck and shoulders.
- Stop action if they are doing anything that you deem dangerous.
- If the web breaks you may stop the activity and make repairs or start the review.

Activity Variations

There are several variations that will create greater challenges and change the dynamics of the entire group in meaningful ways.

Web Hole Sizes

For the classic web pattern, providing various size openings can challenge the group in different ways. Be sure to allow enough generous sized openings for the largest members of the group to pass through safely.

Too Few Participants

If there appears to be too many openings, instead of closing any, or altering the web, try having the participants pass through several objects, such as 4x4's, picnic coolers, storage boxes, stuff sacks, an open umbrella, an inflated beach ball, etc.

Team Instructions

GOAL: To get the highest final score you can.

You have 5 minutes to pre-plan a strategy and then tell the facilitator what the plan is. The facilitator will help to make sure your strategy is safe.

Scoring

A point is scored each time a person passes entirely through an opening in the web without touching it.

Once a person goes through an opening, the hole is closed. No one else can go through that hole.

If each person in the group scores, all the holes reopen and can be used again to score additional points, if time permits.

If any person touches a string at any time, all must return to the starting side of the web, the score returns to zero, and all holes are open for scoring.

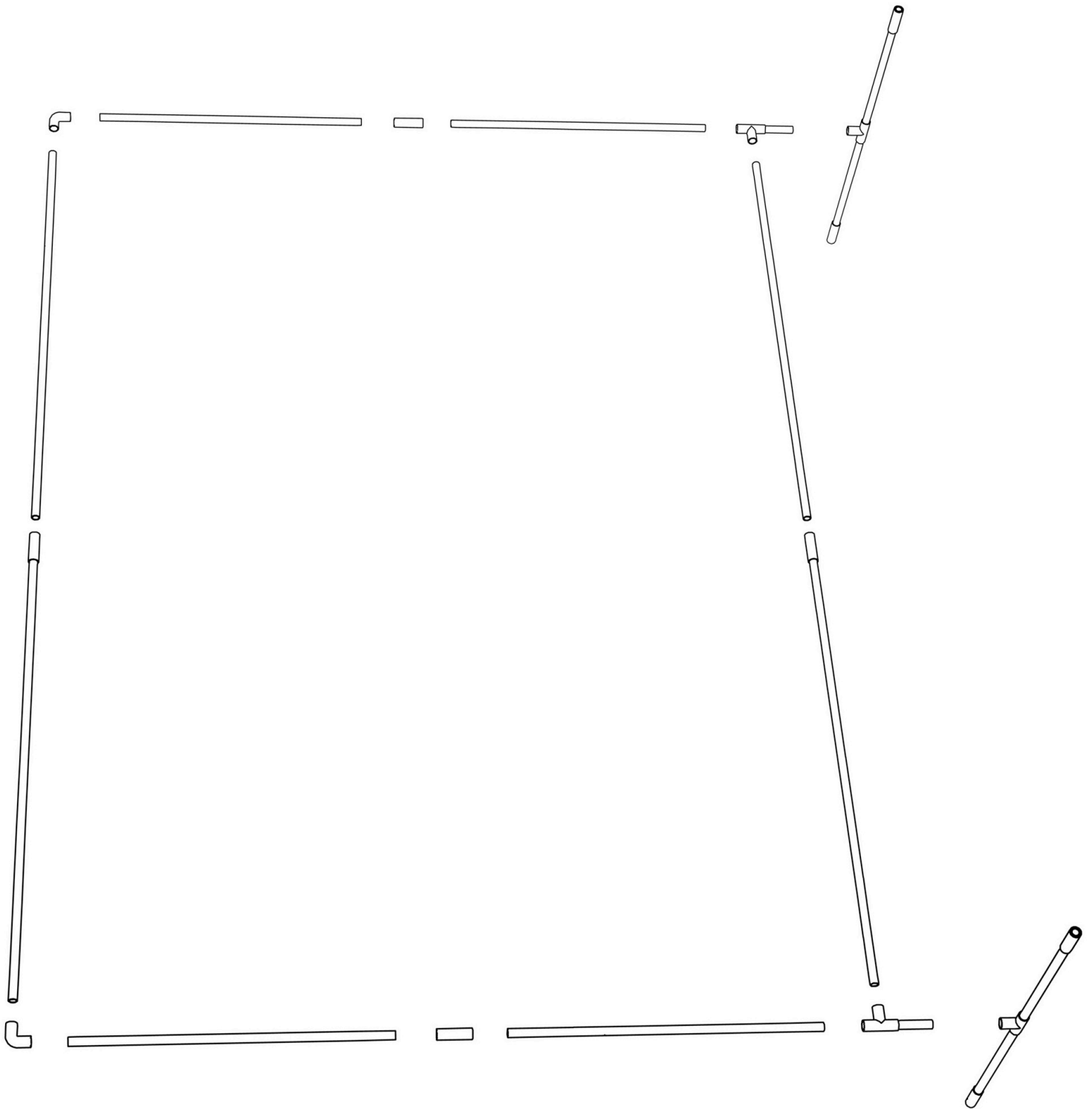
All members of your group must start from the original side of the web.

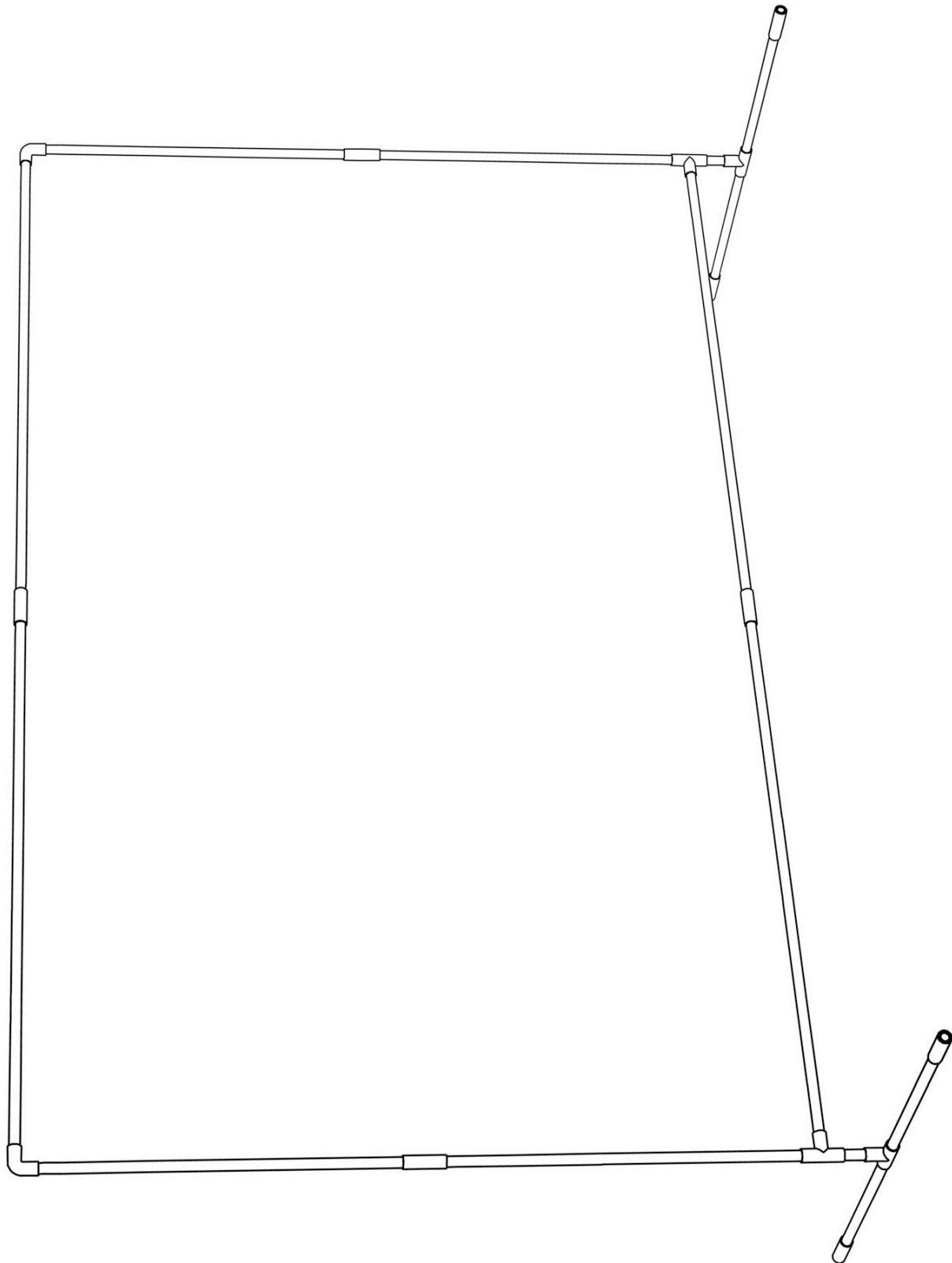
No one may go over or around the web, except when returning to start over.

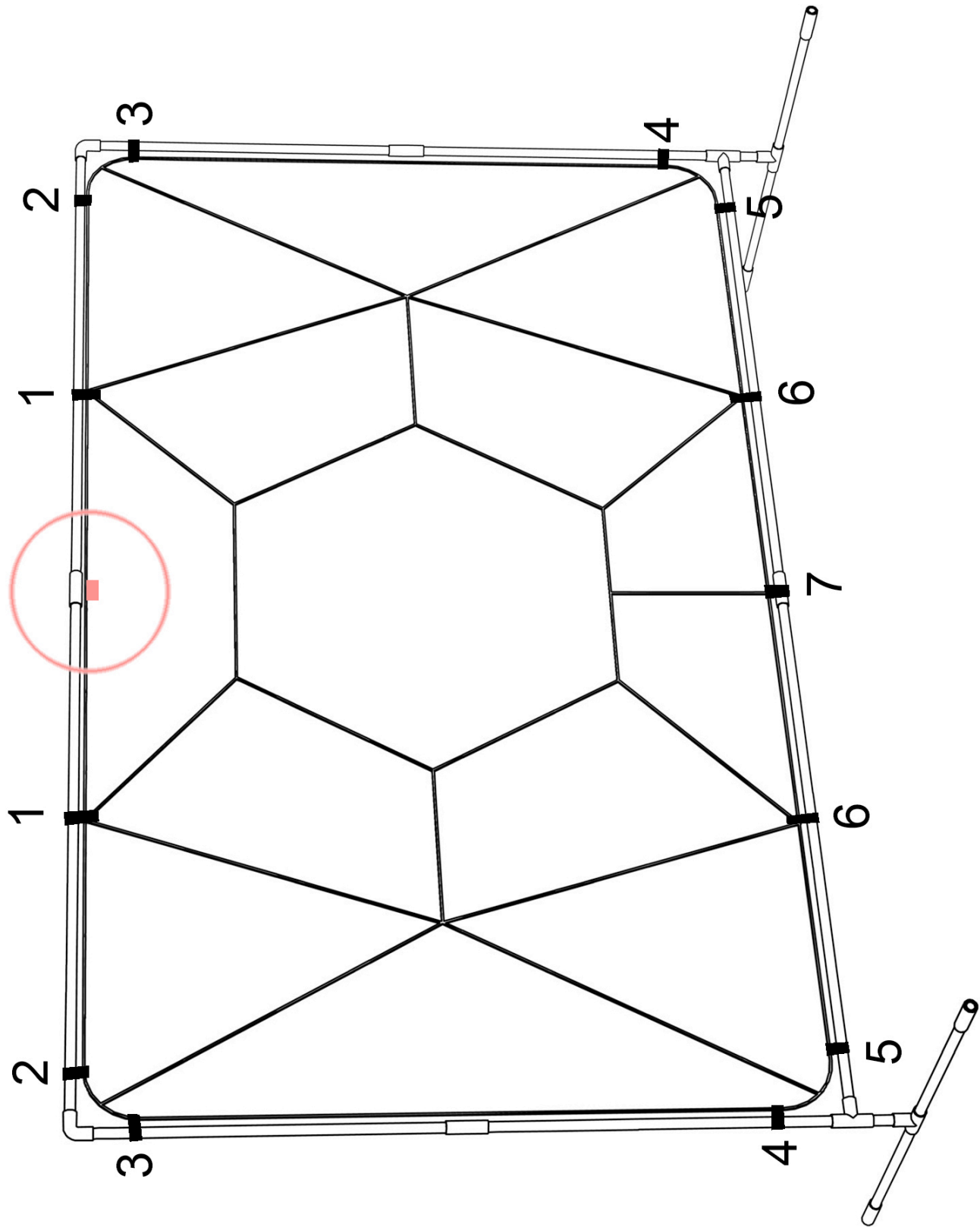
You may not alter the web in any way.

Both the coach and the team members are responsible for monitoring touches of the web.

Each member of the team is responsible for the safety of all other members of the team. Be sure that the head and shoulders of any person being lifted and/or passed are well supported.







Discussion Questions

1. At the beginning of the activity, did everyone know what their duties were?
2. Were any of the original plans altered during the course of the activity? Why?
3. Would additional planning have prevented these alterations?
4. If contact occurred with the web, what was the reaction of the group to the person that noted the contact?
5. What lessons can you take away from this activity?

Dynamics to Watch for in the Group and Individuals

Contact will occur as a result of the activity.

Make sure the contact is appropriate.

Horizontal Web Setup

Objective

For the entire group to travel from one side of the web to the other.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- Horizontal PVC Frame - see page 13
- Bag of soft balls
- Web made from bungee
- Guidebook



Setup

The horizontal web is similar to the vertical web in many ways in terms of the setup and the execution. However, there are some striking differences in setup and execution of the activity. On page 14 are two illustrations that will help you build the horizontal web.

Potential Storyline

Reference: Feeding the Zircon Gorilla by Sam Sikes

You are all part of a special team, chosen for its effectiveness. You have been asked to find information in a competitor's computer system to set benchmarks for your own company. You have successfully avoided the elaborate security system and gathered the information you need. Now you have to get out before the security officers make their rounds. Unfortunately, one obstacle remains between you and freedom.

A high tech alarm system has been activated that will seal off the building and alert authorities if its laser beams or force fields are disturbed. A reset switch has been placed under the flooring on your side of the system that can be activated by the weight of everyone on your team standing the floor on that side. (In other words, if the alarm is rung, everyone has to start over from the beginning.) The gaps in the laser network seal off each time a body passes through the hole. A force field exists on the far side of the system between the floor and the edge. Another one foot high strip exists between the ceiling and the edge on the near side.

Work carefully and safely and you may make it out free and with those huge bonuses you were promised.

Variations

- Must be connected in some manner. Connections cannot be broken while inside the web.
- Several objects must be retrieved as the group travels to the far end of the rectangular horizontal web.

Tips and Tricks

The frequency at which the traditional spider web has been facilitated to teams has made this small change in set-up key to keeping the activity fresh. The traditional web has a well-defined strategy for completion. People look at the horizontal web and assume a similar strategy, but the solution is quite different.

Humans do not stand up by rising straight up. You will see this assumption tested by almost every team that tries the horizontal web. It is great to watch.

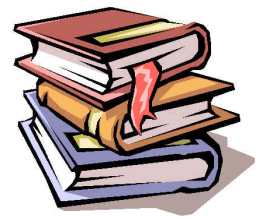
I have found that the holes can be a little larger on the horizontal web and still be a challenge. Even if the holes are large the team still has to figure out how to get people from the hole to the far side of the web without disturbing it.

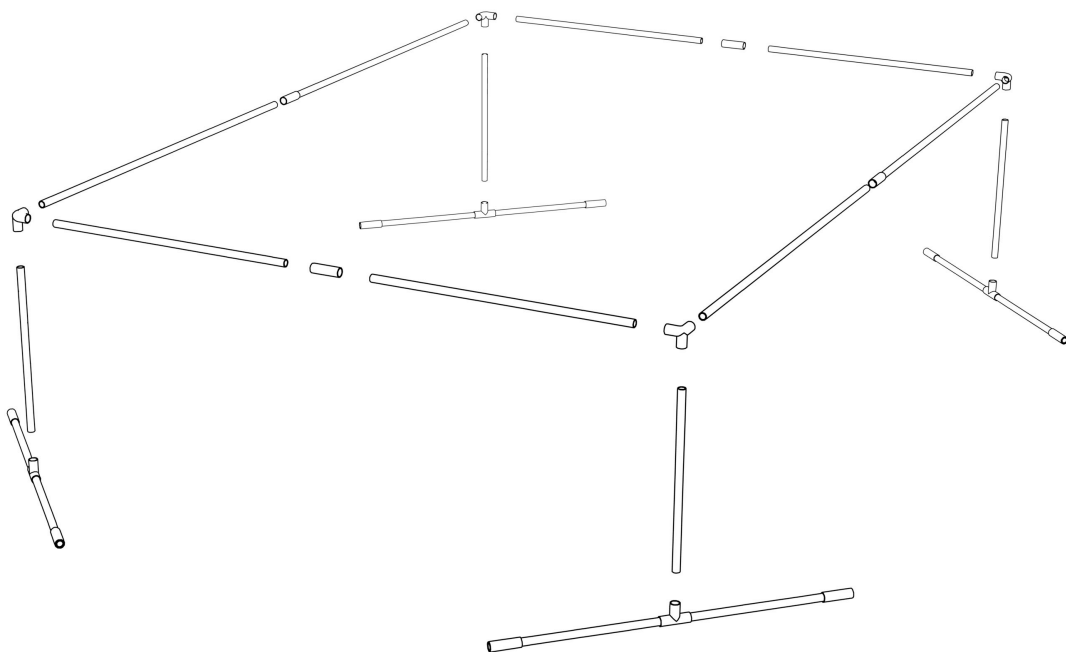
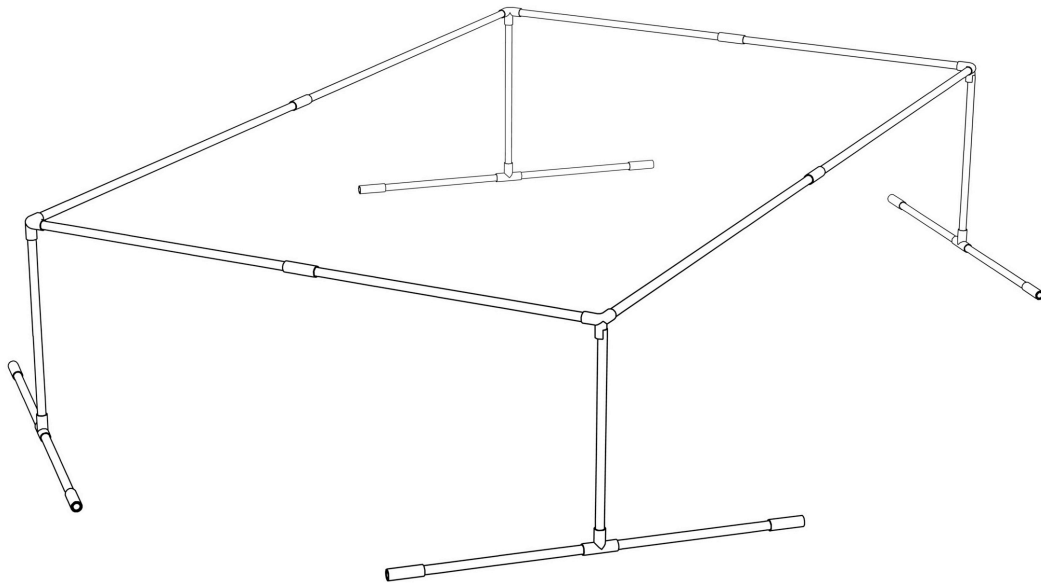
Safety Considerations

The facilitators **MUST** emphasize the importance of spotting and personal safety.

Spotting rules:

- If they begin to step on the backs of others, remind them to not step directly on the spine or the neck of another participant. Instruct them to step on the shoulder and hips, if necessary.
- Only one participant will be moved at a time.
- The facilitator spots the first two participants over the fence, and then the groups are fully responsible for spotting. The facilitator will also spot the last participant out.
- The facilitator does not physically support the participants unless necessary in the instance of a fall.
- Spot until the person in transit is completely over the fence and on the ground.
- Be careful to spot the head and shoulder all the time.
- Do not let someone be a “step” for too long.
- Heads and shoulders must always be above the feet.





Electric Fence

Objective

The objective of this exercise is to get the entire group from one side to the other.

Ask the participants to imagine that this is an electric fence with a force field from the top of the fence to the ground and stretches on forever in either direction.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

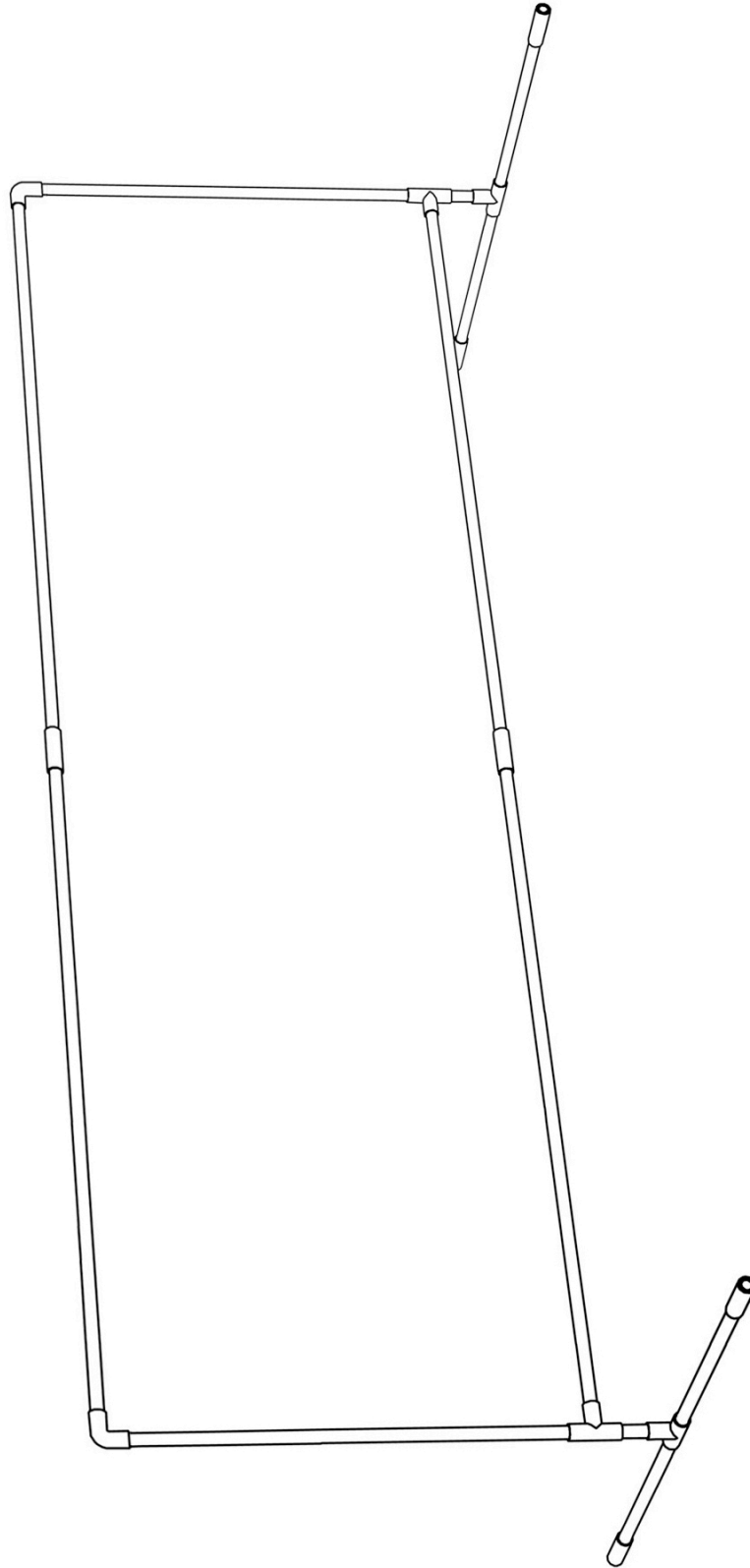
- PVC Frame
- Guidebook

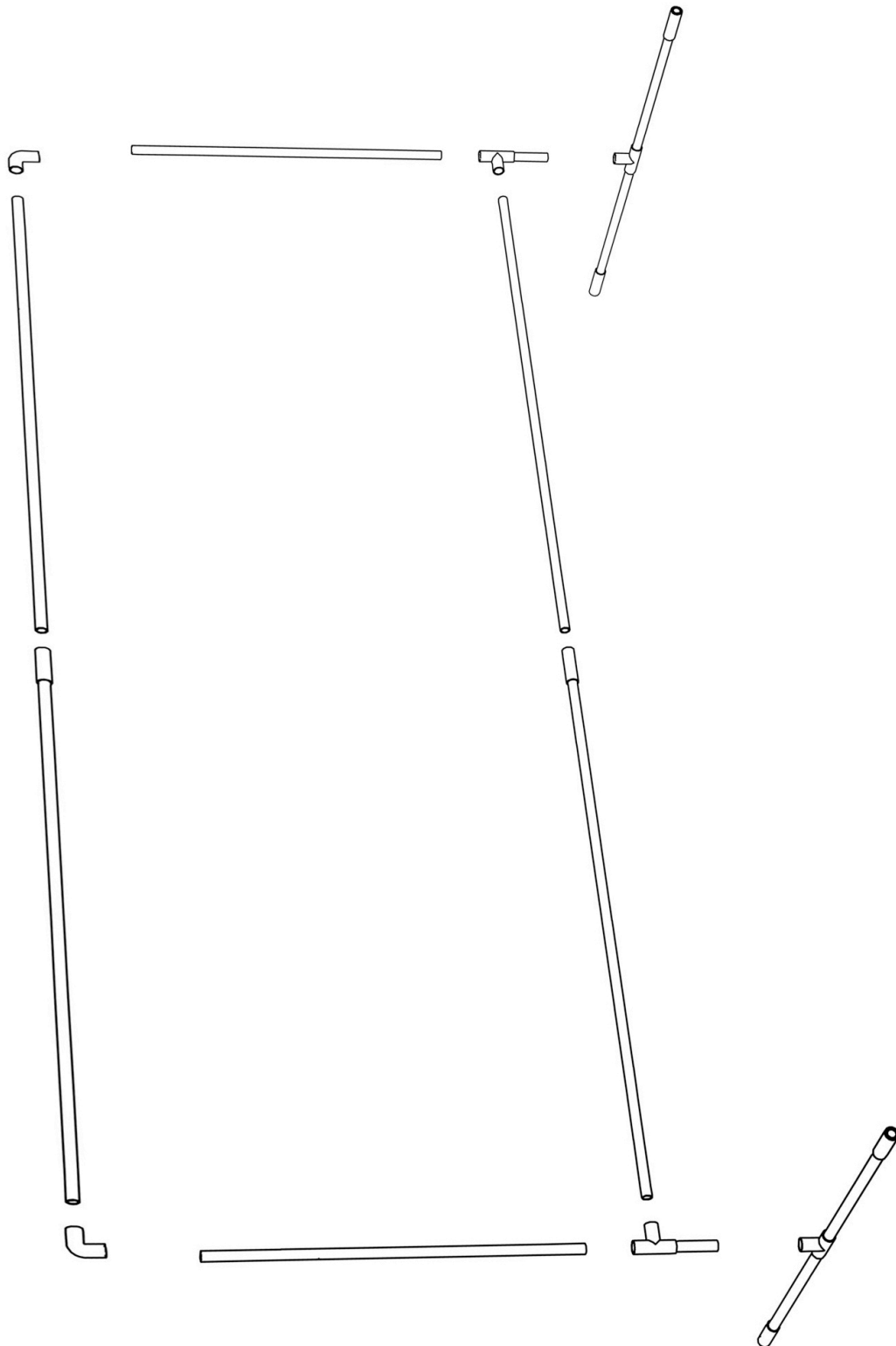


Setup of Activity

1. Assemble PVC frame as shown in the illustrations on page 15-16.
2. Tell the group the objective of the activity and the rules below.
3. The first person may not run and jump over the fence. He may not exit head first. The last person may not jump the fence, or otherwise exit under their power alone. Encourage group work.
4. When going over the fence, participants may NOT touch the fence, nor break the plane under the fence.
5. If members touch the rope or break the plane, they “lose” the use of the body part that touched the rope. So, for example, if someone accidentally hits the rope with his arm, he has to hold that arm across this body and cannot use it to help others over, or use it to help him get over the rope later.





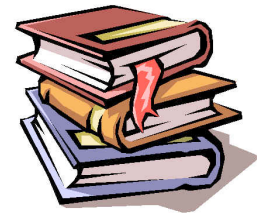


Safety Considerations

The facilitators **MUST** emphasize the importance of spotting and personal safety.

Spotting rules:

- If they begin to step on the backs of others, remind them to not step directly on the spine or the neck of another participant. Instruct them to step on the shoulder and hips, if necessary.
- Only one participant will be moved at a time.
- The facilitator spots the first two participants over the fence, and then the groups are fully responsible for spotting. The facilitator will also spot the last participant out.
- The facilitator does not physically support the participants unless necessary in the instance of a fall.
- Spot until the person in transit is completely over the fence and on the ground.
- Be careful to spot the head and shoulder all the time.
- Heads and shoulders must always be above the feet.



Potential Discussion Questions

1. What did you think of the activity before we began and what do you think of it now?
2. What did you feel after you finished it?
3. Was the group challenged by this exercise?
4. Was communication strained? Why?
5. How did the group accept individual ideas?
6. Who led or followed during this exercise? Why?
7. What type of positive or negative reinforcement did you receive?
8. What would you do differently in your next attempt?
9. How would you work better as a team?
10. What lesson can you take from this and apply to your life?

Hole in Space

Objective

Move the entire group through the center hole in the web, the 'Hole in Space' as quickly as possible.

This is a fine event for demonstrating to a group that they can improve their efficiency performance by discussing previous attempts and by working together as a team. Decrease in performance time can be dramatic.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- PVC Frame
- Bungee Web
- Guidebook
- Timer - a watch or clock works fine.



Setup of Activity

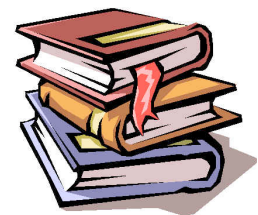
1. Assemble the Spider Web vertical PVC frame. See pages 7 - 9.
2. Attach bungee web.
3. Tell the group the objective and the rules.

Safety Considerations

The facilitators **MUST** emphasize the importance of spotting and personal safety.

Spotting rules:

- If they begin to step on the backs of others, remind them to not step directly on the spine or the neck of another participant. Instruct them to step on the shoulder and hips, if necessary.
- Only one participant will be moved at a time.
- The facilitator spots the first two participants through the hole, and then the groups are fully responsible for spotting. The facilitator will also spot the last participant out.



- The facilitator does not physically support the participants unless necessary in the instance of a fall.
- Spot until the person in transit is completely through the hole and on the ground.
- Be careful to spot the head and shoulder all the time.
- Heads and shoulders must always be above the feet.

Potential Discussion Questions

1. What do you think about this activity?
2. Was the group challenged by this exercise?
3. Did your time improve as you attempted the same activity over? Why?
4. How did the group accept individual ideas?
5. Who led or followed during this exercise? Why?
6. How could you work better as a team?
7. How did it feel to be completely dependent upon others for your safety? Are there areas in your life in which you have to completely trust others for your safety? Physical AND emotional safety?
8. Do you easily extend trust to others? Why or why not?
9. Who do you give your complete trust? What if you extended trust to more people in your life? What might happen?
10. What lesson can you take from this and apply to your life?



Dynamics to Watch for in the Group

Watch to ensure proper contact is occurring. Especially as this is a timed event! In a timed event, people cut corners, bend and sometimes break rules. Sometimes social rules. Emphasize proper contact is essential for the emotional safety of the entire group and an unbreakable rule.

Support

Call Us at 800-513-8759!

We are absolutely happy to help you with any questions you might have with your materials or activities.

www.TeamBuildingActivity.com

Visit our website for additional support, videos , variations and more. Our launch will be on January 1, 2013!

As part of your purchase, you will have access to the information for the activities included in this guide. You will also have access to facilitator information which will help you execute these activities better.

